Discover: The Moon's Journey

Today I can… ☐ State that the Moon orbits Earth in roughly a month. ☐ Explain that moonlight is reflected sunlight. ☐ Explain phases using our changing view of the lit half.

Feedback: ☐ VF ☐ WS ☐ I ☐ NS ☐ E ☐ R ☐ [//] ☐ [?] _____

Word page

The Moon's Journey

Blue shows word meanings.

satellite — an object that orbits a planet

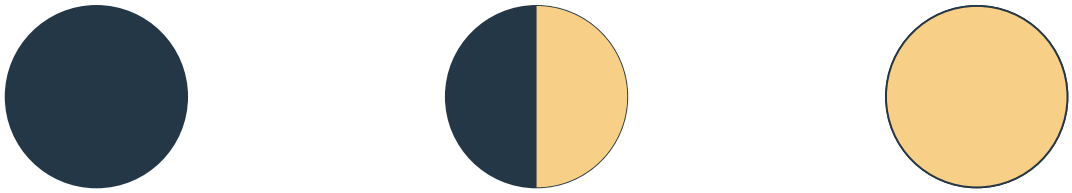
phase — the shape of the lit part of the Moon visible from Earth

orbit — a curved path around another body

reflected — light that changes direction from a surface

New, half and full are views from Earth. The Moon stays round; its visible lit part changes.

Orange shows the part seen lit. Dark blue shows the part not seen lit.



new Moon | half Moon | full Moon

Views from Earth; not to scale.

The ball stays round at every position.